afraid of the word *model*: the best models are actually pretty simple. In Impact Mapping, for example, you use a simple mind-mapping approach to identify and compare the relative value of features, mapping them back to their underlying business goals. The Purpose-Based Alignment Model is another graphing technique that can help you decide how much effort you should invest in each feature. Models make it easier to discuss the assumptions that underlie the value proposition of each feature, and they prevent low-value features from slipping in unnoticed.

We'll look at several of these models and techniques in more detail later in this chapter.

3.2.2 Inject the features

As you've seen, once you've identified the goals of your project and how it's expected to deliver value to the business, you can objectively decide what features are worth including in the application. But you can do better than that. A team practicing Feature Injection doesn't just decide what features in the product backlog are worth doing; they proactively look for features that will deliver business value.

One of the fundamental tenants of Feature Injection is that the value of a piece of software generally comes from the outputs. For example, the value of an application comes from the information it provides, the sales that result from its use, or the reports it generates that allow users to make decisions. It comes from the financial transactions that it processes or from the sold products it ships. Value is to be found not in the inputs, but in the outputs.

When you want to know what features will deliver the most value, or the most return on investment, you should start with the outputs or outcomes. Take the outputs that will deliver the most value, and work back to find the minimum set of features you need in order to produce these outcomes. For example, you might identify the following features that could contribute to the goal of increasing sales revenue:

- Increase sales by allowing Frequent Flyer members to purchase flights with redeemed miles.
- Increase sales by allowing travellers to book flights online.

Again, this is quite similar to the Impact Mapping approach, where you start with a business goal and work back to discover the features that could deliver this goal.

3.2.3 Spot the examples

When you inject features this way, you only get a partial view of how a feature might work. A high-level feature description such as "Purchase flights with redeemed miles" or "Book a flight online" only gives a superficial idea of how a feature should behave. When it comes to implementing such a feature, you obviously need to know more.

Once you have a high-level set of features that you want to implement, you need to expand your understanding so that you can cater for the variety of inputs or behavior that may affect the outcomes. In other words, you need to expand the scope of the features that you'll build until you're satisfied that they'll deliver the business value you expect of them.